Phase 1 – DRM Policy Framework Maturity Assessment: Colombia

> *Note: Maturity levels are assigned based on a synthesis of World Bank project documents, the Colombia Country Climate and Development Report (2023), GFDRR engagement records, and other publicly available sources as of early 2025. This table is intended as a discussion draft and should be validated with in-country teams and government counterparts.*

Maturity Level Key:

- Nascent — Frameworks drafted/proposed; coordination limited; instruments absent or early-stage
- Emerging — Frameworks adopted; initial implementation begun; basic institutional setups; tools piloted
- Established — Frameworks/plans implemented across sectors; institutional arrangements operational; instruments regularly utilized
- Advanced — Full integration and institutionalization; comprehensive coverage; sophisticated, sustainable, and regularly updated systems

---

Pillar 1: Legal & Institutional Framework

DRM Sub-Pillar	DRM Action	Maturity Level	Comments & Assessment
National DRM/DRR Laws	What national DRM/DRR laws exist?	Advanced	Law 1523 of 2012 (Ley 1523) established the comprehensive legal framework for DRM, replacing earlier reactive legislation (Law 46/1988 and Decree-Law 919/1989). It created the National System for Disaster Risk Management (SNGRD) and shifted the approach from post-disaster response to integrated risk management. Climate Change Law (2018) further reinforced the framework.
Institutional Mandate & Coordination	Is there a lead institution with a clear mandate?	Advanced	The National Unit for Disaster Risk Management (UNGRD) was elevated to an administrative department under the Office of the President, giving it strong political leverage. It coordinates across national, sectoral,

			and subnational levels through the SNGRD, which integrates the National Environment System, National Planning System, and other coordination platforms.
National DRM Strategy / Plan	Is there a National DRM Plan?	Advanced	The National Disaster Risk Management Plan (PNGRD 2015–2030) is in place, aligned with the Sendai Framework, the SDGs, and the Paris Climate Agreement. It has been updated with GFDRR support. The Plan defines programs, budgets, and responsible institutions across risk knowledge, risk reduction, and disaster management.
Integration into National Development Plans	Is DRM integrated into national development planning?	Advanced	DRM has been a specific and prominent element in every National Development Plan (PND) for the past three decades. The current PND 2022–2026 (Law 2294 of 2023) continues this tradition, incorporating climate risk and disaster resilience as cross-cutting priorities aligned with "Colombia Resiliente."
Subnational Institutional Arrangements	Are subnational entities empowered for DRM?	Established	Over 900 municipalities have developed DRM plans and Local Committees for Disaster Prevention and Response operate at local, municipal, and departmental levels. However, capacity gaps persist at the subnational level—UNGRD's capacity to fully support all territorial entities remains stretched, and resource allocation for risk reduction (vs. disaster

			management) remains imbalanced.

Pillar 2: Risk Identification

DRM Sub-Pillar	DRM Action	Maturity Level	Comments & Assessment
Hazard Mapping & Risk Assessments	Are multi-hazard risk assessments conducted?	Established	UNGRD published a National Risk Atlas in 2018 covering seismic hazard, flooding, tsunamis, tropical cyclones, forest fires, drought, and landslides. In 2024–2025, UNGRD (with Pacific Disaster Center support) completed comprehensive scientific risk and vulnerability assessments for all 1,122 municipalities across 11 hazard types. Multi-hazard risk profiles at departmental level are available.
Data & Information Systems	Are risk data systems operational and accessible?	Established	The SIGPAD geospatial and risk data platform exists, and a Municipal Disaster Risk Index (updated in 2024 to include water-related risks such as drought and forest fire) guides resource allocation. However, earlier assessments noted integration challenges—only partial information-sharing agreements among SNGRD entities had been operationalized.
Risk Information for Decision-Making	Is risk information used in public investment decisions?	Established	DNP consistently integrates risk perspectives into public investment decisions. The CONPES framework regularly addresses risk issues. However, the share of line ministries systematically using official risk information across all investment projects

			remains an ongoing challenge noted in recent World Bank assessments.
Climate Risk Integration	Is climate risk systematically integrated into risk assessments?	Emerging	The 2021 CONPES 4058 approved a Public Policy to Reduce Disaster Risk Conditions and Adapt to Climate Variability. Eight ministries have developed Comprehensive Sectoral Climate Change Management Plans. However, systematic integration of climate risk into all sectoral assessments and at the subnational level is still progressing. The Early Warning System for climate variability, foreseen in the 2020 NDC, has yet to be fully designed and implemented.

Pillar 3: Risk Reduction

DRM Sub-Pillar	DRM Action	Maturity Level	Comments & Assessment
Land Use Planning	Is DRM integrated into land use plans?	Established	Law 1454 (LOOT, 2011) provides the framework for integrating DRM into territorial and land use planning. Over 280 municipalities have updated land use regulations to address hazards. MAVDT and UNGRD have assisted more than half of Colombia's 1,101 municipalities in integrating DRM into land use plans.
Building Regulations & Standards	Are building codes in place and enforced?	Established	Updated Earthquake Resistant Standards (NSR-10) were issued via Decree 926 of 2010 and further refined in 2011. The city of Cali developed a 12-year

			school infrastructure resilience plan. A grant program for protection of housing vulnerable to seismic risk targets low-income households. Enforcement at the subnational level remains an area for improvement.
Public Investment Management	Is DRM mainstreamed in public investment management?	Established	DRM criteria are incorporated in the national public investment management cycle through CONPES documents and PND mandates. DNP monitors municipal investments in risk reduction. However, the Colombia CCDR (2023) notes that key components—such as an updated resilient infrastructure plan and a dedicated resilience unit for the transport sector—are still lacking or need improvement.
Sectoral Risk Reduction	Are sector-specific DRM standards in place?	Established	Green Road Infrastructure Guidelines have been integrated into the Ministry of Transport's manuals (with GFDRR support), addressing resilience of transport infrastructure in hazard-prone areas. Technical guidelines for planning roads in hazard-prone areas are being adopted. Climate-resilient housing programs and concession insurance frameworks have also been strengthened.
Hydrometeorological Risk Reduction	Are hydrometeorological risks specifically addressed?	Established	Hydrometeorological phenomena account for 85% of disasters in Colombia. The PNGRD and CONPES frameworks

			specifically address these risks. Watershed basin management integrates risk considerations through Regional Environmental Autonomous Corporations (CARs). Agricultural insurance schemes are being implemented, though their coverage remains limited and some have not been scaled beyond pilot stage.

Pillar 4: Emergency Preparedness

DRM Sub-Pillar	DRM Action	Maturity Level	Comments & Assessment
Early Warning Systems (EWS)	Are multi-hazard EWS operational?	Established	Colombia has expanded coverage of its hazard monitoring network (seismic stations, volcanic monitoring stations, automatic hydrometeorological stations). The PNGRD includes an EWS strategic line. However, the 2020 NDC identified the design and implementation of a climate variability EWS as still pending, and the Colombia CCDR (2023) confirms gaps in systematically connecting EWS to emergency warning dissemination at community level.
Contingency Planning	Are contingency plans in place at national and subnational levels?	Established	Decree 2157 of 2017 establishes general guidelines for DRM Plans, including risk identification, risk reduction, and disaster management components with contingency planning requirements. Over 900 municipalities have DRM plans. Colombia's four-level

			disaster response structure (local, municipal, departmental, national) is operational and regularly tested through simulations.
Emergency Response Capacity	Is emergency response operational?	Advanced	The SNGRD has proven its operational capacity through multiple activations—notably the 2010–2011 La Niña floods (Cat DDO disbursed within weeks), COVID-19 in 2020 (Cat DDO II disbursed in full), and El Niño 2022. Simulations and drills are regularly conducted. UNGRD's coordination role under the Presidency enables rapid mobilization, though emergency response still commands a disproportionate share of DRM investment relative to risk reduction.
Adaptive Social Protection	Are social protection programs linked to disaster preparedness?	Emerging	Programs exist to support vulnerable households during disasters. Colombia's social protection systems provided income and nutrition support during COVID-19 and past disasters. However, a fully climate-sensitive adaptive social protection system—automatically triggered by disaster events—is not yet in place. About 6.7 million people remain socially vulnerable and exposed to floods and landslides.

Pillar 5: Financial Protection

DRM Sub-Pillar	DRM Action	Maturity Level	Comments & Assessment

Fiscal Risk Assessment	Has the government quantified its fiscal exposure to disaster risk?	Advanced	With World Bank support, Colombia's Ministry of Finance prepared a comprehensive study estimating contingent liabilities from natural disasters. CONPES 3545 (2008) provided the basis for a contingent financing framework. The 2012 MHCP framework identified three priority policy areas for managing disaster-related fiscal risk.
Disaster Risk Financing Strategy	Is a layered DRF strategy in place?	Advanced	Colombia has one of the most sophisticated DRF strategies in Latin America. The layered approach includes: (i) the National Fund for DRM (FNGRD); (ii) four successive Cat DDO instruments with the World Bank (2008–2025); (iii) a $400 million contingent loan from IDB (2025); (iv) catastrophe risk derivatives; and (v) innovative local instruments such as Manizales' parametric insurance triggered by rainfall data.
Contingency Funds	Are contingency funds operational?	Advanced	The National Fund for DRM (FNGRD, reconstituted from the former National Calamity Fund under Law 1523) is operational, with clear rules and procedures for co-financing DRM actions at different government levels. The fund has been activated multiple times.
Public Asset Insurance	Is insurance for public assets systematically in place?	Established	Insurance of public assets is mandatory in Colombia. With World Bank/SECO support, a database of public assets and insurance

			policies was developed, and standardized terms and conditions for public asset insurance were proposed and partially implemented through the Public Procurement Agency. Coverage and standardization at the subnational level require further strengthening.
DRM Budget Tagging	Is DRM spending tracked in the national budget?	Established	DRM investment is tracked, with reported allocations (e.g., US$755 million in 2010). However, the breakdown shows a persistent imbalance: historically 78% of investment goes to disaster management, 19% to risk reduction, and only 3% to risk knowledge—a recognized gap that the government is working to address.

Pillar 6: Resilient Reconstruction

DRM Sub-Pillar	DRM Action	Maturity Level	Comments & Assessment
Post-Disaster Recovery Framework	Is there a legal/policy framework for post-disaster recovery?	Established	Colombia has accumulated significant reconstruction experience (e.g., FOREC after the 1999 Armenia earthquake; recovery programs after La Niña 2010–2011). Law 1523 mandates recovery as part of the DRM cycle. However, the Colombia CCDR (2023) notes that a comprehensive "Building Back Better" (BBB) strategy, as envisioned in the PND 2018–2022, has not yet been formally developed. Reconstruction

			processes have historically taken more than five years.
Post-Disaster Needs Assessment (PDNA)	Are standardized PDNA tools in place?	Established	Colombia has conducted post-disaster assessments, including a mid-term evaluation of La Niña 2010–2011 reconstruction (with GFDRR support in 2016). UNGRD coordinates inter-institutional damage and needs assessments. However, a formalized, nationally standardized PDNA framework consistent with international tools is not yet fully institutionalized.
Building Back Better Principles	Are BBB principles embedded in reconstruction?	Emerging	Colombia's reconstruction programs have demonstrated BBB elements in practice (e.g., Cali school infrastructure, resilient transport guidelines). The PND 2018–2022 called for a disaster-resilient recovery strategy with explicit BBB principles, but this strategy was not fully developed as of the 2023 CCDR. The Cat DDO IV (2025) is expected to advance this agenda, including through updated PNGRD alignment with climate adaptation.
Subnational Reconstruction Capacity	Do subnational entities have reconstruction capacity?	Established	Colombia's four-level response and recovery architecture distributes responsibilities across national, departmental, and municipal levels. UNGRD provides technical assistance to subnational entities. The updated Cartagena District DRM Plan (with GFDRR support) illustrates growing subnational capacity.

			However, capacity remains uneven, with smaller municipalities facing significant resource and technical constraints.

Summary Assessment

DRM Pillar	Overall Maturity Level
1. Legal & Institutional Framework	Advanced
2. Risk Identification	Established
3. Risk Reduction	Established
4. Emergency Preparedness	Established
5. Financial Protection	Advanced
6. Resilient Reconstruction	Established

Key Strengths: Colombia is widely recognized as a regional leader in DRM, particularly in its legal and institutional framework (Law 1523/2012, UNGRD under the Presidency) and its sophisticated, multi-layered disaster risk financing strategy (four Cat DDO cycles, contingent credit lines, and innovative local instruments). DRM has been consistently mainstreamed in national development planning for over three decades.

Key Gaps and Priority Areas:

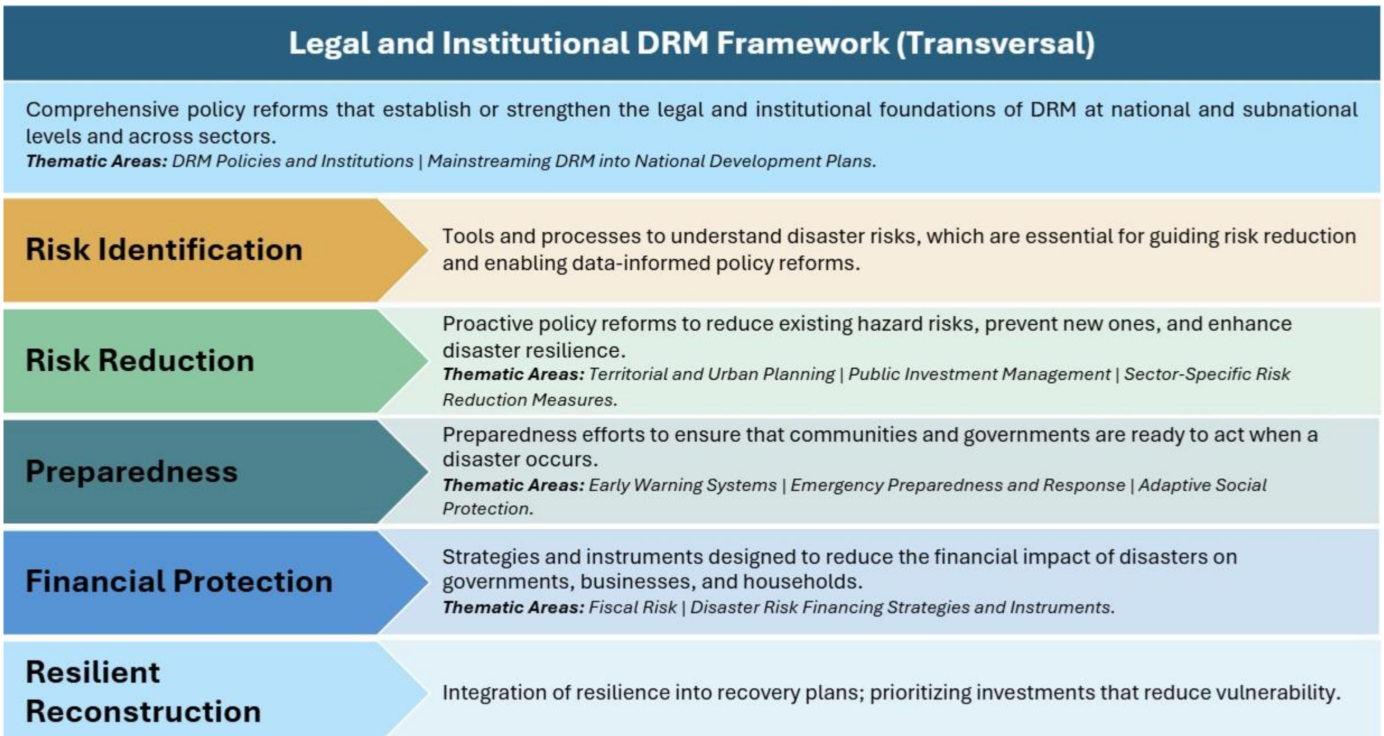
- Adaptive social protection systems linked to disaster triggers are nascent and require scaling.
- A comprehensive Building Back Better strategy with formal principles and guidelines for post-disaster reconstruction has yet to be finalized.
- Subnational capacity—particularly for risk knowledge, EWS, and risk reduction investments—remains uneven and is disproportionately under-resourced relative to emergency response.
- Climate risk integration across all sectoral planning and investment processes is advancing but incomplete.
- DRM investment allocation remains skewed toward disaster management at the expense of risk reduction and knowledge generation.

This document was generated by mAI.

Phase 2 – DRM Policy Framework Screening: Colombia

Introduction

The objective of this web tool is to allow practitioners to conduct an assessment of the maturity of a country's Disaster Risk Management (DRM) system and identify the main policy gaps that may be constraining resilience-building efforts. Recognizing that a comprehensive DRM policy diagnostic requires a system-wide perspective, this tool is organized around the World Bank's DRM framework, which outlines six key DRM policy dimensions. The reader is referred to the accompanying Methodological Note for a thorough description of the DRM framework and this tool.



This is a high-level assessment designed to be objective and quick. The tool assesses each DRM pillar using a set of closed Yes/No questions presented in an offline questionnaire. Users should review official documentation (legal, regulatory, institutional, and budgetary) and consult with colleagues and national authorities to provide an informed answer. This is particularly relevant for cross-cutting questions, where inputs from colleagues from sectors such as Water, Transport, Education, Health, and Agriculture may help in gathering information. Once all questions are completed, the web tool will generate key metrics and visual outputs.

Assessment Results

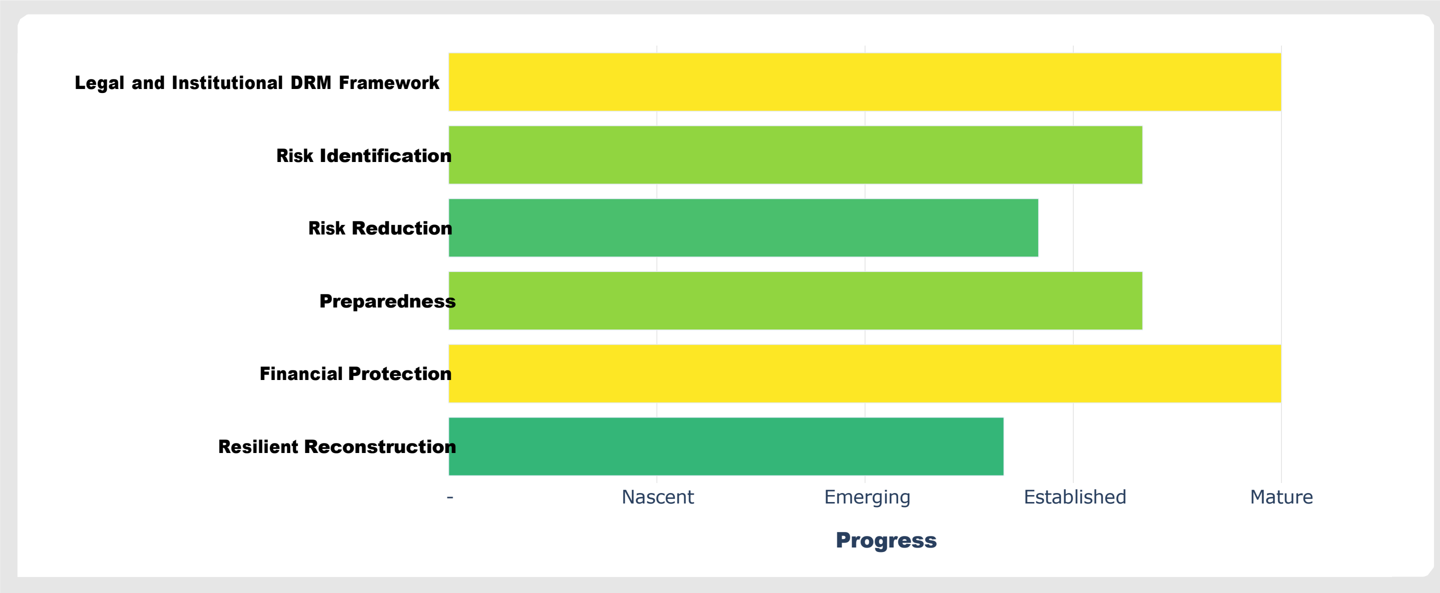
The petal diagram encapsulates the assessment results. Each petal represents a thematic area of the DRM framework, grouped by thematic area. Below the diagram, results are aggregated by DRM pillar to highlight key drivers and gaps.

- **Petal length** reflects progress in that thematic area: the longer the size of the petal, the more advanced the country is.
- **When a petal extends beyond the red circle**, minimum policy requirements for that area are considered in place.
- **Countries with mature DRM systems** typically have most petals exceeding the red circle, with some approaching the frontier (i.e., exhibiting a level of advances close to the global benchmark frontier).

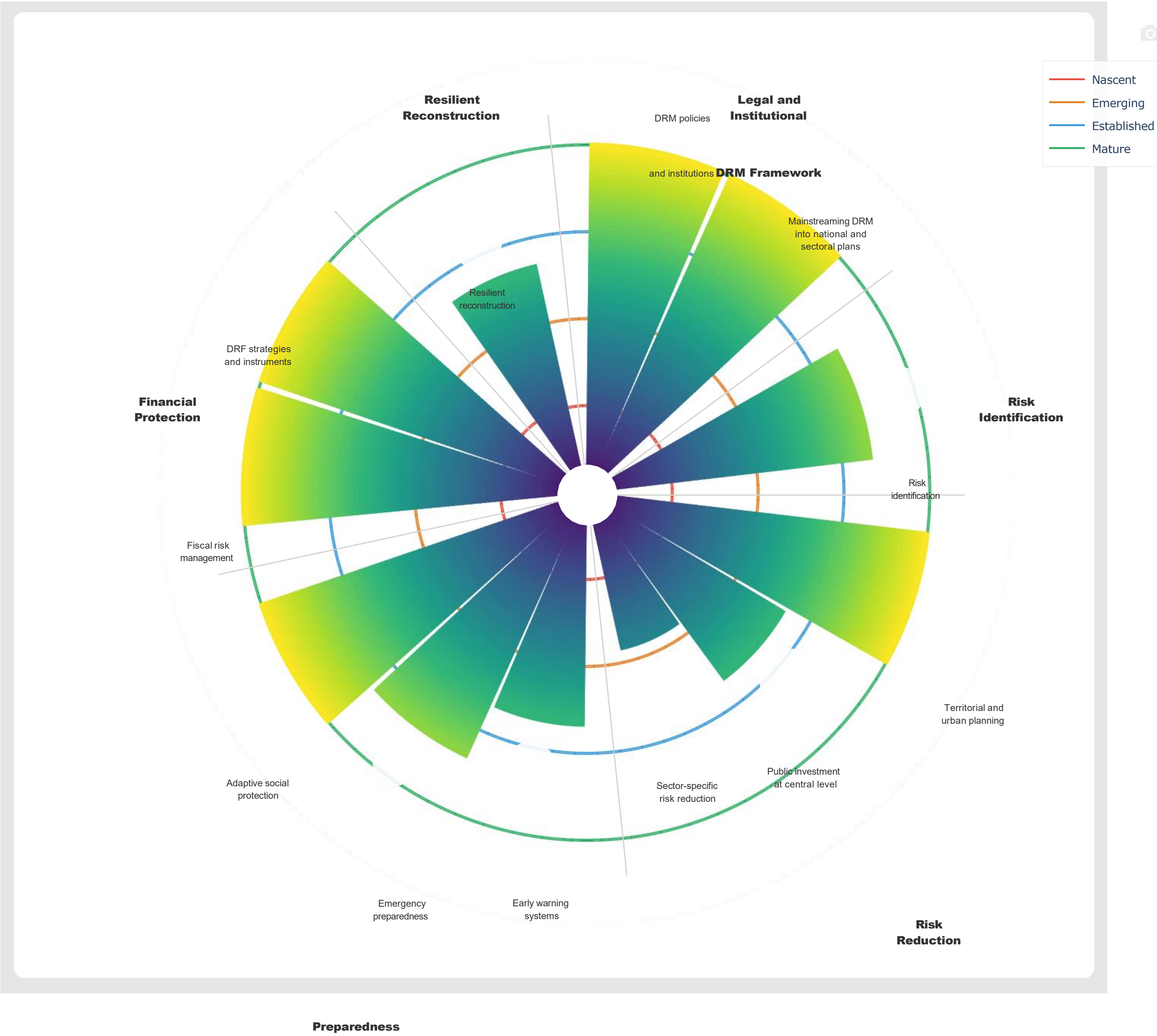
The diagnostic should be seen as a starting point for structuring a DRM policy dialogue—not as a final evaluation. Shorter petals indicate areas where the policy framework is weak and/or not producing the expected outcomes. Depending on a range of factors (e.g., political momentum, internal resources, country prioritization), this policy area may be prioritized for further support. Ultimately, this tool supports policy dialogue—whether to inform the preparation of a Cat DDO operation or to guide Technical Assistance—helping countries shift from reactive disaster response toward a proactive, strategic approach to managing disaster and climate-related risks.

While the evaluation reflects lessons learned and good practices that can serve as a foundation for a robust DRM policy framework, it should not be interpreted as prescriptive guidance. Disaster risk is highly context-specific, and this diagnostic represents only an initial step toward developing an appropriate and effective DRM policy program. Task teams are encouraged to consult the report *Driving Resilience Through Policy Reforms* for further guidance on how to structure a context-relevant DRM policy program.

Results by DRM Pillar



Results by Thematic Area



✓ **Congratulations! All assessed areas meet or exceed the minimum standard.**

This text was generated automatically by a Large Language Model (LLM). Users should verify the content and cross-reference with official documentation.

DRM policies and institutions

In Colombia, all core components of the DRM institutional environment are in place: a legal framework, dedicated funding, a formally approved strategy, and up-to-date regulations. This combination indicates a mature and coherent system with clear roles, strategic direction, operational guidance, and financial support. Institutional capacity for DRM is likely to be strong.

Mainstreaming DRM into national and sectoral development plans

Both the national development strategy and the majority of essential government entities explicitly incorporate DRM or climate adaptation priorities in their strategic plans. This alignment demonstrates a strong mainstreaming of risk considerations across levels of government, supporting a coherent and coordinated approach to resilience.

Risk identification

In Colombia, institutional responsibilities are clear, government entities have access to data, and climate change impacts are considered. However, citizens cannot access hazard and risk information, suggesting strong governance and forward-looking analysis internally but limited transparency.

Territorial and urban planning

All core elements are in place: laws mandating risk use, official methodologies, guidelines for high-risk areas, and recent instruments incorporating risk information. This indicates a comprehensive, risk-informed approach to territorial and urban planning in Colombia.

Public investment at the central level

In Colombia, laws and official guidelines exist for disaster and climate risk screening, but mitigation measures are not mandatory. Screening is legally and technically supported, yet high-risk projects may still proceed without guaranteed risk reduction.

Sector-specific risk reduction measures

Transport, education, and health standards and hazard-resistant building codes exist, but energy infrastructure lacks standards. Roads, schools, hospitals, and buildings are resilient, though energy remains vulnerable. Retrofitting projects have been funded, but water and sanitation arrangements, integrated water management, watershed improvements, and sewage coverage are lacking. Some infrastructure is strengthened, but systemic water sector resilience is limited.

Early warning systems

In Colombia, institutions are coordinated and populations were promptly alerted, but there has been no budget allocation for the hydrometeorological network. Early warning operations reach the public effectively, but technical capacity and sustainability are limited.

Emergency preparedness and response

Legal framework, national protocols, and gender-sensitive measures exist, but subnational contingency plans are missing. National preparedness and inclusivity are strong, yet subnational capacity needs strengthening.

Adaptive social protection

A comprehensive adaptive social protection system is in place: legal framework, unified social registry, and timely support during disasters. Vulnerable populations are systematically targeted and assisted through well-coordinated ASP mechanisms.

Fiscal risk management

A comprehensive fiscal risk management system is in place: institutional structure, quantified disaster liabilities, fiscal documents with risk assessments, and stress tests including disaster and climate scenarios. Colombia demonstrates robust governance, analytical capacity, and preparedness for fiscal shocks.

DRF strategies and instruments

In Colombia, sovereign risk financing instruments, insurance regulations, and increased available financing are all in place. The country demonstrates strong financial preparedness to manage the impact of disasters and climate-related shocks.

Resilient reconstruction

Planning instruments are reviewed and assessment guidelines exist, but institutions are not defined. Reconstruction shows operational measures and assessment capacity, but lacks formal governance.